



Even more refinements popping up, thanks to good ol' Mamma

Power search

Use the Power Search option found on the main page to fine-tune your search. Here, under 'Select search sources', you can select the directories and indexing engines to be used by Windows. Under Pay-Per-Click, you can safely choose to ignore all the options, since the results displayed here may not be relevant to your search. Set adult content reduction, if desired, and other options such as highlighting search terms. Also, set the other options for speed, number of results displayed (keep it low for fast page loading), descriptions, and whether you want the results to open in a new window.

Dogpile

Another of those massive Web crawling search engines, Dogpile (www.dogpile.com), gives you results from across a wide variety of search engines. Use Dogpile to search from Google, Yahoo!, AltaVista, Ask

Jeeves, About, and other search engines at a single go.

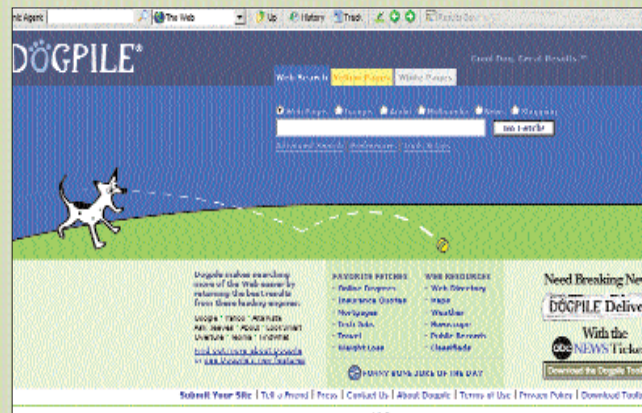
Web search

Dogpile's Web Search is simple and easy to use. You can pre-refine your search by choosing between Web searches, images, audio, multimedia, new and shopping. This will limit your results to those categories.

Setting preferences

Setting the adult filter here will ensure that all your Dogpile searches are filtered. Also, set the other options such as language, automatically correcting misspelled terms—clicking on this will auto-correct all spellings, a feature you may not like unless you make typos often. You can also set the way you want the results displayed. This can be arranged either by relevance, or grouped by search engine. Ideally, choose relevance, as this will remove obvious duplicates in the results. However, if you find too few results, it makes sense to view results by search engine. You might also like to have all results open in a separate browser window; this feature can be enabled by checking 'Open Search Results Links in New Window'.

Remember, you need to let your browser accept cookies so that you can save these preferences as default.



Use Dogpile to sniff out elusive Web pages

Advanced search

Dogpile's advanced search is accessed from the main page. Start off by qualifying your searches with key terms that you want or don't want listed on the results—the Dogpile advanced search option makes a exact phrase search, as well as a search using either some or all of the listed keywords. You can also use Boolean search terms instead, by using a combination of 'AND', 'OR' and 'NOT'.

More search options

For more search power, you might consider using the domain search option under Advanced Search. You could start with restricting searches to, or excluding searches from, top-level domains such as .com or .edu, or get more specific with specific domains such as Microsoft.com. The 'Last Page Update' option will let you obtain results that were listed before an update on the target date, or you could choose to see results after an update on a certain date.

Audio search

The audio search is a pretty nifty tool. Input search keywords, and you'll get links to audio files that fit the description, or the keywords you entered. And no, this isn't a smart way to start downloading warez; copyrighted content is pretty much non-existent.

Multimedia

The multimedia option is for searching for video files. The results you get are in the form of links to sites hosting video content in a variety of formats.

News, shopping

Dogpile's primary news feeds are culled from ABC News, and they aren't always the latest around, but you can also get feeds from the FAST search engine, with quick, up-to-the-minute results. Shopping is also an option with Dogpile, but it's US-centric, and will, at best, give you an indication of product prices.



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